VEDM: Veterans Exploring Dance & Music

Program & Support Guide • compiled from vedm.org (retrieved 11 November 2026)

Compiled by Michael Israelitt for MOT 6115 coursework from publicly available vedm.org content. Not an official VEDM publication. Program dates and details may change; confirm at vedm.org or info@vedm.org.

1. Who we are

VEDM is a 501(c)(3) tax-exempt nonprofit (EIN 33-3346225) that creates connection, community, and creative experiences for veterans through electronic music, movement, and peer culture. Donations are tax-deductible to the fullest extent permitted by law.

Mission statement: “VEDM creates connection, community, and creative experiences for veterans through electronic music, movement, and peer culture. We help veterans reconnect with purpose, belonging, and self-expression beyond the uniform.”

Vision: “To be the world’s leading veteran community built around electronic music: a place where service members find connection, purpose, and creative expression beyond the uniform.”

Founders: VEDM was founded by two Air Force veterans. **Izzy** (Founder & Executive Director) served seven years as an Air Force Special Warfare Officer; electronic music became his community after service. **Gerry** (Co-Founder & Director of Programs) is a ten-year Air Force veteran with an MSW and a clinical mental health background; he contributes to program safety, peer-connection design, and evaluation methodology.

"Electronic music is the medium. The community is the work."

2. What VEDM is, and is not

VEDM is **community programming, not a clinical service**. It works alongside veterans' therapy, treatment, and recovery with qualified professionals: never as a substitute, never as a clinical alternative. VEDM's programs are designed to be safe and durable, and to recognize when to refer a member to clinical care.

3. Core values

- **Community:** inclusive spaces where veterans support one another and rebuild belonging.
- **Authenticity:** individuality, honesty, vulnerability, and self-expression without judgment.
- **Creativity & Self-Expression:** music, dance, and movement as connection, not as treatment.
- **Purpose and Empowerment:** experiences that encourage growth, leadership, and personal development.
- **Thoughtful Program Design:** shaped by research, lived experience, and ongoing input from veterans served.
- **Accessibility:** welcoming to all veterans regardless of background, experience, or ability.

4. Programs

4.1 VEDM Cohort (active; Cohort 01 launches Spring 2027, interest list open)

Status	Cohort 01 launches Spring 2027, planned alongside Encanti Music Academy's Spring 2027 Freshman class. Dates to be announced.
Partner	Encanti Music Academy (Ben "Encanti" Cantil's Freshman course). Encanti donates course access.
Structure	One-month program: four weekly live sessions covering composition, sound design, track development, and mixing, plus peer connection, a guest instructor session, and an alumni community.
Group size	6–8 veterans taking the course together.

Format	Online. Encanti's weekly live classes are taught in Ableton Live. VEDM peer cohort calls run on Zoom, with the Encanti Music Academy Discord.
Eligibility	US veterans with a DD-214. Any era, any branch, any discharge status other than dishonorable.
Cost	Free to participants.
Participants receive	Course access (class recordings and the Academy Discord community), weekly peer cohort calls, a guest instructor session, and alumni community access. A DAW subscription and entry-level gear (e.g., MIDI controller and headphones) may be provided based on need and available funding.
How to join	Fill out the onboarding survey on vedm.org/programs; it also serves as the interest list sign-up.

4.2 VEDM Crews (in development)

Status	In development; vedm.org states launch is anticipated in 2026. No dates have been published.
Structure	Crews of 6–12 veterans attend electronic music festivals or shows together, with a pre-event call, an in-event buddy framework, and a post-event decompression call.
Eligibility	Same as Cohort: US veterans with a DD-214.
Requirements	Insurance, an operational framework, and partnerships that VEDM is building toward.
Funding	Donor-funded through the "Build VEDM's Next Programs" giving track.
How to join	Join the Crews interest list on vedm.org/programs.

4.3 Future exploration

VEDM is exploring local recurring community gatherings in Atlanta and a deeper alumni program for veteran producers. Both are in early planning.

5. How to get involved

- **Veterans:** VEDM's music and movement experiences are free, welcoming, and designed with veterans in mind. Complete the onboarding survey (Cohort interest list) or the Crews interest list, or use "Connect With VEDM" (info@vedm.org) to get event updates.
- **Volunteers, partners, and in-kind gifts:** email info@vedm.org to offer time, skills, instruments, or equipment, or to discuss partnerships.
- **Newsletter:** sign up at vedm.org for cohort news, partnership announcements, and program developments.
- **Community channels:** Instagram and Twitch @vedm_project; Facebook and Discord (links on vedm.org).

6. Ways to give

Your donation funds the specific category you choose, and VEDM tracks donations by category so your contribution supports the work you intended. An optional checkbox lets donors cover the 3% processing fee.

Track 1: Fund a Veteran's Cohort Experience (one-time)

$25	One month of production software access for a Cohort participant
$75	Full production software access for one participant for the program
$250	Production gear (MIDI controller + headphones) for one Cohort participant

$500	A guest instructor session for an entire Cohort
$1,000	Half-funds a full Cohort
$3,000	Fully funds a Cohort of 6–8 veterans
Custom	Any amount

Track 2: Build VEDM's Next Programs

$150	Insurance and infrastructure for forthcoming in-person and event-attendance programs
$750	Underwrites a veteran's participation in VEDM's first Crew when the event-attendance program launches
Custom	Any amount

Track 3: Sustain the Organization (one-time or monthly)

$25/month	Sustains essential infrastructure (insurance, compliance, banking)
$100/month	Major sustaining support for ongoing operations
Custom	Any amount

Only the Sustain track offers a monthly (recurring) option. Governance, compliance, insurance, and banking are not program-funded, which is why the Sustain track exists.

7. Frequently asked questions

How are donations used? 100% of contributions are directly invested into VEDM programs and operations.

What does VEDM provide for veterans? Through the VEDM Cohort (Cohort 01 launches Spring 2027), participants get free Encanti Music Academy course access, weekly peer cohort calls, a guest instructor session, and alumni community access, and may receive a DAW subscription and entry-level gear (MIDI controller, headphones) based on need and available funding. Group attendance at festivals and shows is planned through VEDM Crews, which is in development; no dates have been published. Join the Crews interest list on vedm.org/programs.

Can I donate instruments or time, or partner with VEDM? Yes. Contact info@vedm.org.

Are donations tax-deductible? Yes. VEDM is a 501(c)(3) organization (EIN 33-3346225), and charitable donations are tax-deductible to the fullest extent permitted by law. Receipts are provided on request.

Does VEDM provide therapy? No. VEDM is community programming, not a clinical service, and works alongside (never instead of) professional care.

8. If you are in crisis

Veterans Crisis Line: dial 988 and press 1, text 838255, or chat at VeteransCrisisLine.net. **988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline:** call or text 988 (988lifeline.org). In an emergency, call 911.

9. Contact

Email: info@vedm.org • Web: vedm.org • Instagram and Twitch: @vedm_project • Facebook and Discord: links on vedm.org • Blog: "The Brief" at vedm.org/blog

Sources (retrieved 11 November 2026): vedm.org/home, vedm.org/programs, vedm.org/about-us, vedm.org/our-mission, vedm.org/our-team, vedm.org/volunteer, vedm.org/donate, vedm.org/blog.